
Q1: Griefly explain chronemics along with examples.

Chronemics is the study of the use of **time** in communication. It focuses on how people **perceive, structure, and value time**, and how time influences communication behavior.

◆ **Example 1:** In the United States (a monochronic culture), people value punctuality and schedule one task at a time. A delay in a business meeting may be seen as disrespectful.

◆ **Example 2:** In Latin America or the Middle East (polychronic cultures), people are more flexible with time. They may handle multiple tasks at once and see time as fluid.

Q2: What is verbal communication?

Verbal communication refers to the **exchange of information through spoken or written words**. It involves the use of **language, tone, pitch, and clarity** to convey a message.

◆ **Examples:**

- A teacher explaining a topic in class (spoken verbal communication).
- An email sent to a colleague (written verbal communication).

Verbal communication is essential for expressing thoughts clearly and is used in speeches, presentations, discussions, and written documents.

Q3: Write a brief note on culture and ethical values perceived the value.

Culture refers to the **shared beliefs, customs, behaviors, and values** of a group or society. It shapes how people **interact, communicate, and perceive right and wrong**.

Ethical values are the **moral principles** that guide a person's or society's behavior. They include honesty, integrity, fairness, respect, and responsibility.

◆ **Perceived Value:** Culture greatly influences what people consider ethical. For example, in Western cultures, **individualism** and **freedom of expression** are highly valued, whereas in Eastern cultures, **collectivism** and **respect for elders** may take precedence.

Businesses operating globally must respect different cultural norms and ethical expectations to maintain harmony and trust.

Q4: Mention a few rules of email etiquette.

Here are some key rules of **email etiquette**:

1. **Use a clear subject line** (e.g., “Meeting Request – July 17”).
 2. **Begin with a polite greeting** (e.g., “Dear Mr. Ahmed”).
 3. **Be concise and to the point.**
 4. **Use professional language and tone.**
 5. **Avoid using slang or emojis.**
 6. **Proofread your message before sending.**
 7. **Add a proper closing** (e.g., “Regards, Sarah Malik”).
-

Q5: Cover Letter for the Post of a Manager

To:

The Human Resource Manager
XYZ Multinational Pvt. Ltd.
Lahore, Pakistan

Subject: Application for the Post of Manager

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my interest in the position of Manager at your esteemed organization. With over **5 years of professional experience** in leadership roles and a strong background in business administration, I am confident in my ability to contribute positively to your team.

I hold a **BBA (Hons.) degree** from Punjab University and have consistently demonstrated **excellent communication, organizational, and problem-solving skills** throughout my career. My ability to **lead teams, manage operations, and drive performance** makes me a suitable candidate for the position.

Moreover, I have a proven record of achieving targets, implementing strategic initiatives, and maintaining productive client relationships. I value ethical practices and a collaborative work environment, which aligns with your company’s values.

Please find my resume attached. I would be grateful for an opportunity to discuss my application further.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,

Ali Raza
Email: aliraza@email.com
Phone: 0300-1234567

Q6: Brief Report on Pakistan's Economic, Political & Labour Market (Requested by VP of International Marketing)

To:

Vice President, International Marketing
ABC International Corporation
New York, USA

Subject: Brief Report on Pakistan's Economic, Political, and Labour Market
Situation

Introduction:

This report provides a concise overview of Pakistan's **economic conditions, political climate, and labor market**, as requested. It serves as a foundational input for future business decisions and expansion strategies.

Body:

Economic State:

Pakistan's economy is **developing**, with agriculture, textiles, and IT being major sectors. Despite **challenges like inflation, currency devaluation, and high debt**, the government is focusing on **economic reforms** and digitization. The IMF and other institutions are supporting stabilization efforts.

Political Situation:

Pakistan is a **federal parliamentary republic**. The political environment is **semi-stable**, with regular democratic elections. However, **occasional political unrest** and **bureaucratic delays** may impact foreign investment. Government policies favor foreign businesses through **SEZs and tax incentives**.

Labour Market:

Pakistan has a **large, youthful labor force**, with over 60% population under age 30. Skilled and semi-skilled workers are available at **competitive wages**. However, there is a **skills gap** in high-tech sectors. Vocational training programs are expanding to meet industry needs.

Conclusion:

Pakistan presents **both opportunities and risks**. With a growing economy and young workforce, it is an attractive market for investment, provided that political and policy risks are managed carefully.

Please let me know if you need a more detailed report.

Prepared by:

Ali Raza

Marketing Research Assistant

Email: ali.raza@abcintl.com

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Q.1. Answer the following short questions (6×5 = 30 marks)

(a) Why is effective communication necessary in business?

Effective communication is necessary in business because it:

- Builds strong relationships with customers, employees, and stakeholders.
- Ensures that information is clearly delivered and understood.
- Reduces misunderstandings, mistakes, and conflicts.
- Increases efficiency in operations and decision-making.
- Supports teamwork, motivation, and goal achievement.

 *Example:* A well-written email with clear instructions avoids confusion among employees.

(b) What do we mean by culture?

Culture refers to the **shared values, beliefs, norms, customs, behaviors, and traditions** of a group of people. It influences how individuals think, communicate, and interact in society or within an organization.

✚ *Example:* In some cultures, making direct eye contact shows confidence; in others, it may be seen as disrespectful.

(c) Why is it important to understand the cultural values of a particular group in business communication?

Understanding cultural values is important in business communication because it:

- Promotes respect and avoids unintentional offense.
- Helps build trust and good relationships in international business.
- Enhances negotiation and teamwork.
- Increases the chances of business success in global markets.

✚ *Example:* In Japan, bowing is a sign of respect. Knowing this can help during meetings with Japanese clients.

(d) What do you mean by ethical concerns in business communication?

Ethical concerns in business communication refer to the principles of **honesty, transparency, fairness, and responsibility** when sharing information.

Unethical communication includes lying, manipulating facts, or hiding critical information.

✚ *Example:* Falsely advertising a product's benefits is unethical and can damage a company's reputation.

(e) Write five parts of a business letter.

1. **Sender's Address**
2. **Date**
3. **Recipient's Address**
4. **Salutation (e.g., Dear Sir/Madam)**
5. **Body of the Letter**

Other parts include: Subject line, Closing, Signature, and Enclosures (if any).

(f) What is a refusal letter?

A **refusal letter** is a formal document used to **decline or reject a request, proposal, or offer** in a polite and professional manner. It explains the reason for the rejection while maintaining a positive tone to preserve future relationships.

✦ *Example:* A company may send a refusal letter to an applicant who was not selected for a job.

✓ Q.2. Answer the following questions (3×10 = 30 marks)

(a) Write a letter congratulating the G.M. of a business firm on completion of twenty-five years of business life.

Ali Raza

House #456, Gulshan-e-Iqbal
Karachi, Pakistan

15 July 2025

To,

The General Manager
Success Enterprises Pvt. Ltd.
Karachi, Pakistan

Subject: Heartiest Congratulations on 25 Years of Business Success

Dear Sir,

I am writing to extend my warmest congratulations to you on the successful completion of **twenty-five years** in the business world. This milestone is a remarkable achievement and a testament to your **vision, leadership, and dedication**.

Over the years, your firm has earned a reputation for excellence, integrity, and customer satisfaction. Your achievements have not only contributed to the growth of your company but have also inspired countless entrepreneurs in the industry.

May you continue to reach new heights of success in the years ahead.

Once again, congratulations!

Yours sincerely,
Ali Raza

(b) Write a report for your GM appraising him of the need for new ideas to boost the business.

To: General Manager
From: Assistant Business Analyst
Date: July 15, 2025
Subject: Report on the Need for New Business Ideas

Introduction:

The purpose of this report is to highlight the growing need for **innovation and fresh business strategies** to sustain competitive advantage and increase profitability.

Body:

1. **Stagnant Sales:**
Recent sales data shows a **decline in growth**, indicating customer interest is dropping in our current offerings.
 2. **Market Trends:**
The market is evolving rapidly, with competitors launching **new digital services** and engaging in **creative marketing**.
 3. **Customer Feedback:**
Surveys suggest that customers are seeking more **personalized experiences** and **tech-based solutions**.
 4. **Employee Input:**
Team brainstorming sessions have revealed several practical and cost-effective ideas to **revamp branding**, **enhance social media presence**, and **introduce loyalty programs**.
-

Conclusion:

To remain competitive and grow sustainably, it is crucial to adopt **new business ideas and innovation-driven approaches**. I recommend setting up a dedicated innovation team and organizing a quarterly idea contest for employees.

Submitted by:

Ali Raza

Assistant Business Analyst

(c) Write a job application for the post of software engineer in a reputable company.

Ali Raza

House #789, Garden Town

Lahore, Pakistan

Email: aliraza@email.com

Phone: 0300-9876543

15 July 2025

To,

The HR Manager

TechVision Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Lahore, Pakistan

Subject: Application for the Post of Software Engineer

Dear Sir/Madam,

With due respect, I am writing to apply for the position of **Software Engineer** as advertised on your company's website. I have completed my **Bachelor's degree in Computer Science** from Punjab University and possess **over two years of experience** in full-stack development.

My skills include proficiency in **Java, Python, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, and ReactJS**, along with strong experience in **API integration, software testing, and debugging**. I have worked on multiple projects where I developed web-based applications and collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver efficient software solutions.

I am confident that my **technical expertise**, along with my **commitment to learning and teamwork**, make me a suitable candidate for your growing company.

I have attached my resume for your consideration and would welcome the opportunity to further discuss how I can contribute to your team.

Yours sincerely,

Ali Raza

✓ Part-I: Short Answer Questions (4×5 = 20 marks)

1. Define the concept of culture.

Culture is the **shared system of values, beliefs, customs, behaviors, and symbols** that members of a society use to interpret their world. It includes language, traditions, dress, food habits, rituals, and social norms passed from one generation to the next.

✦ *Example:* In Japanese culture, bowing is a gesture of respect.

2. Discuss philosophical perspective concerned with ethics and moral issues.

The **philosophical perspective** on ethics deals with the study of **what is right or wrong, good or bad behavior**. Philosophers such as **Aristotle, Kant, and John Stuart Mill** have presented different ethical theories:

- **Utilitarianism (Mill):** The right action is the one that brings the greatest happiness for the greatest number.
 - **Deontology (Kant):** Morality is based on rules and duties, not consequences.
 - **Virtue Ethics (Aristotle):** Ethics is about developing good character and virtues.
-

3. What do you know about the history of technological development? Explain.

The **history of technological development** traces human progress through inventions and innovations:

- **Stone Age:** Use of tools and fire.
- **Industrial Revolution (18th–19th century):** Steam engine, mechanization, and factories.
- **20th Century:** Electricity, automobiles, telephones, and computers.
- **21st Century:** Internet, smartphones, artificial intelligence, and robotics.

✦ *Technology has transformed communication, production, healthcare, and daily life.*

4. Define and briefly discuss periodic report.

A **periodic report** is a type of business report prepared at regular intervals (daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly) to provide **updates on ongoing activities, performance, or issues**.

✦ *Example:* A monthly sales report showing revenue, targets, and expenses.

Purpose: To help management monitor progress and make informed decisions.

✓ Part-II: Subjective Questions (15×2 = 30 marks)

Q3. Define a proposal and explain the parts of the proposal. (15 marks)

✓ Definition of Proposal:

A **proposal** is a **formal written document** that offers a solution to a problem or recommends a plan of action. It is used in business to **suggest projects, improvements, or investments**.

✦ *Example:* A company may submit a proposal to launch a new product or improve the delivery system.

✓ Parts of a Proposal:

A standard business proposal includes the following parts:

1. Title Page:

- Includes the proposal title, name of the company or author, date, and client's name.
-

2. Table of Contents (Optional):

- Helps the reader navigate through the document.
-

3. Executive Summary:

- A brief overview of the entire proposal.
 - States the problem, proposed solution, and expected benefits.
-

4. Introduction:

- Explains the background of the issue or problem.
 - States the purpose of the proposal.
-

5. Problem Statement:

- Describes the issue in detail.
 - Provides facts, figures, and consequences of not solving the problem.
-

6. Objectives:

- Clearly defined goals that the proposal aims to achieve.
-

7. Proposed Solution/Plan:

- Describes in detail the action plan or solution.
 - Includes timeframes, resources needed, and methods.
-

8. Budget Estimate:

- Gives a breakdown of the financial cost involved in the project.
-

9. Benefits/Justification:

- Highlights how the proposal will benefit the company or client.
 - Justifies why this plan should be accepted.
-

10. Conclusion:

- Summarizes the key points.
 - Requests approval or decision.
-

11. Appendices (If required):

- Additional data, charts, or supporting documents.
-

Summary:

A well-structured proposal is **persuasive, clear, and fact-based**, designed to **gain approval** or **secure funding/support** for a project.

Q4. Write a report on the decline in sales of toiletries. (15 marks)

To: Marketing Manager

From: Assistant Sales Officer

Date: July 15, 2025

Subject: Investigative Report on Decline in Toiletries Sales

1. Introduction:

This report investigates the **reasons for the recent decline** in the sales of our toiletries products over the past few months. The purpose is to identify the causes and suggest practical solutions.

2. Findings (Body):

a) Increased Competition:

Several new brands have entered the market, offering lower prices and attractive packaging.

b) Outdated Packaging:

Our products appear outdated compared to modern, sleek designs offered by competitors.

c) Limited Advertising:

There has been a **decrease in advertising budget** and visibility on social media and TV.

d) Customer Complaints:

Feedback indicates that customers are dissatisfied with the **scent and quality** of some products.

e) Retailer Feedback:

Retailers reported delays in delivery and lack of promotional offers.

 3. Recommendations:

1. **Update product design** and improve quality.
 2. Launch a **marketing campaign** focused on social media.
 3. Offer **discounts or loyalty cards** to boost sales.
 4. Improve supply chain and ensure **on-time deliveries**.
 5. Collect monthly feedback from retailers and customers.
-

 4. Conclusion:

Sales have declined due to a **combination of internal weaknesses and external competition**. By taking immediate corrective actions, we can regain our market share and improve customer loyalty.

Submitted by:

Ali Raza

Assistant Sales Officer

 Part-I: Short Questions (4×5 = 20 marks)

1. Briefly explain the individual cultural variable: Chronemics

Chronemics is the study of how time affects communication. In cultural terms, it refers to how people from different cultures **perceive and use time**.

- **Monochronic cultures** (e.g., USA, Germany): Time is scheduled, linear, and punctuality is highly valued.
- **Polychronic cultures** (e.g., Latin America, Middle East): Time is flexible, multitasking is common, and relationships are prioritized over deadlines.

✦ *Example:* Being late for a meeting in a monochronic culture may be seen as unprofessional, while in polychronic cultures, it may be acceptable.

2. Discuss ethics as an organisational responsibility.

Organizational ethics refer to the moral principles and standards that guide behavior within a company. Ethics are an organizational responsibility because:

- They build **trust** with employees, customers, and stakeholders.
- Prevent **corruption, discrimination, and fraud**.
- Promote a **positive workplace culture** and accountability.
- Protect the organization's **reputation and legal standing**.

✦ *Example:* A company should ensure ethical hiring practices and fair treatment of all employees.

3. Understanding the Internet is increasingly becoming important. What do you have to say?

Yes, understanding the **Internet** is essential in today's world because:

- It is the **primary source of information**, communication, and marketing.
 - Most businesses use online tools for **recruitment, sales, customer service**, and **data analysis**.
 - Employees must be digitally literate to **stay competitive** in the modern job market.
 - The Internet enables **global communication, remote work**, and **e-commerce**.
-

4. Define and briefly explain conventions in writing subject line.

The **subject line** is a short sentence that tells the reader the purpose of an email or letter.

✓ Conventions of a Good Subject Line:

- **Clear and specific** (e.g., “Meeting Request – July 18”)
- **Concise** (use few but meaningful words)
- **Formal** (no slang or emojis)
- **Capitalization** of major words is common
- Avoid vague phrases like “Important” or “Hello”

✎ *A good subject line helps the reader prioritize and understand the message quickly.*

✓ Part-II: Subjective Questions (15×2 = 30 marks)

Q1. Write an analytical report on the promotion of a Deputy Manager under your supervision.

To: Human Resource Manager

From: Ali Raza, Senior Manager

Date: July 15, 2025

Subject: Analytical Report on Promotion of Mr. Usman Iqbal – Deputy Manager

✓ 1. Introduction:

This report presents a performance analysis of **Mr. Usman Iqbal**, Deputy Manager (Sales Division), to determine his **suitability for promotion**. Mr. Usman has worked under my supervision for the past 3 years.

✓ 2. Work Performance Overview:

- **Productivity:** Consistently achieved and exceeded sales targets by 10–15%.
 - **Leadership:** Demonstrated strong leadership in managing a sales team of 12.
 - **Initiative:** Proposed and implemented new reporting formats that improved accuracy.
 - **Discipline:** Punctual, meets deadlines, and follows company policies.
 - **Team Collaboration:** Excellent interpersonal skills; respected by peers and subordinates.
-

✓ 3. Strengths:

- Strategic thinker with strong decision-making skills.
 - Excellent communication and client-handling abilities.
 - Tech-savvy and quick to adapt to new systems.
 - Maintains ethical conduct and loyalty to the company.
-

✓ 4. Areas for Improvement:

- Slight improvement needed in delegation of responsibilities.
 - Time management in high-pressure tasks could be optimized.
-

✓ 5. Conclusion & Recommendation:

Based on Mr. Usman's consistent performance, leadership skills, and contributions to the department, I **strongly recommend his promotion to Manager – Sales**. His promotion would not only boost his morale but also benefit the company's future sales growth.

Submitted by:

Ali Raza
Senior Manager

Q2. Write a follow-up letter to a national company after no response post-interview.

Ali Raza

House #123, Johar Town
Lahore, Pakistan
Email: aliraza@email.com
Phone: 0300-1234567

Date: July 15, 2025

To,
The HR Department
National Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Islamabad, Pakistan

Subject: Follow-Up on Interview Conducted for Software Engineer Position

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to follow up on the **interview I attended on June 15, 2025**, at your campus recruitment drive at Punjab University for the post of **Software Engineer**.

At the end of the interview, I was informed that I would be contacted shortly regarding the final decision. However, as a month has passed with no response, I would like to kindly request an update regarding the status of my application.

I remain highly interested in working with your esteemed organization and contributing to your innovative projects. I would appreciate any information regarding the outcome of my interview.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,
Ali Raza

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Part-I: Short Answer Questions (4×5 = 20 marks)

1. Briefly explain the individual cultural variable: Decision Making

Decision-making as a cultural variable refers to **how individuals or groups make decisions** in different cultures.

- In **individualistic cultures** (e.g., USA), decisions are often made **independently** by a single person or leader.
- In **collectivist cultures** (e.g., Japan, China), decisions are made through **group consensus**, harmony and collective interest.

 *Understanding cultural decision-making helps in effective business negotiation and collaboration.*

2. Why are harassment laws increasingly appearing in every country?

Harassment laws are becoming common because:

- To **protect the rights and dignity** of individuals in workplaces and public spaces.
- To promote **equality, safety, and non-discriminatory environments**.
- To comply with **international human rights standards**.
- Due to **rising awareness**, victims now demand action against abuse, discrimination, or exploitation.

✦ *Workplace harassment laws help build a respectful and productive work environment.*

3. Why are email writing conventions becoming more informal than formal?

Email writing is becoming more informal because:

- **Fast communication culture** encourages shorter, casual messages.
- Workplaces now prefer a **friendly tone** over rigid formalities.
- **Team collaboration tools** (like Slack, Teams) have influenced email style.
- Millennials and Gen Z professionals value **direct and simple communication**.

✦ *However, professionalism should still be maintained in tone and clarity, especially in business settings.*

4. Briefly differentiate between a progress report and a conference report.

Aspect	Progress Report	Conference Report
Purpose	To show ongoing progress of a project or task	To summarize discussions and outcomes of a meeting
Content	Work done, challenges, timeline, next steps	Key points, decisions made, participant feedback
Frequency	Regular intervals (weekly/monthly)	Written after a formal meeting or event

✦ *Progress report tracks task status; conference report summarizes meeting proceedings.*

✓ Part-II: Subjective Questions

Q1. Informational Report: Personnel Turnover in Manufacturing Unit (10 marks)

To: Financial Officer

From: Assistant HR Officer

Date: July 15, 2025

Subject: Informational Report on High Personnel Turnover in Manufacturing Unit

1. Introduction:

This report aims to present the **reasons behind the high turnover rate** in our manufacturing unit and suggest **remedial actions** to improve employee retention.

2. Causes of Personnel Turnover:

- **Low Wages:** Workers feel that compensation is not competitive compared to other factories.
 - **Poor Working Conditions:** High noise levels and insufficient safety protocols have been reported.
 - **Lack of Career Growth:** No clear path for promotion or skill development.
 - **Long Working Hours:** Overtime policies are unregulated, causing burnout.
 - **Lack of Employee Recognition:** Hardworking employees feel undervalued and unappreciated.
-

3. Recommendations:

1. **Review and increase salary structure** to match industry standards.
 2. **Improve health and safety conditions** with better ventilation and training.
 3. Introduce **employee development programs** and certifications.
 4. Implement a **reward and recognition system** to boost morale.
 5. Create a **feedback mechanism** for employees to voice concerns regularly.
-

4. Conclusion:

Addressing these issues will reduce employee dissatisfaction and **lower turnover**, leading to higher productivity and long-term cost savings.

Submitted by:

Ali Raza

Assistant HR Officer

Q2. Define a Resume and Explain Its Parts (10 marks)

✓ Definition of Resume:

A **resume** is a **formal summary** of an individual's education, experience, skills, and achievements, prepared for **job applications**. It helps the employer decide whether to shortlist a candidate for an interview.

✓ Parts of a Resume:

1. **Header/Contact Information**
 - Name, phone number, email, LinkedIn, address.
2. **Career Objective / Summary**
 - A short statement about your professional goals and strengths.
3. **Education**
 - Degrees obtained, names of institutions, dates, and grades (if good).
4. **Work Experience**
 - Job titles, company names, job responsibilities, and dates.
5. **Skills**
 - Relevant technical and soft skills (e.g., MS Office, problem-solving).
6. **Certifications / Training**
 - Any additional courses, workshops, or certifications.
7. **Achievements / Awards**
 - Notable accomplishments in academic or professional life.
8. **References (Optional)**
 - Names of people who can vouch for your qualifications (or "Available on request").

✦ *A resume should be concise, clear, and tailored to the job you're applying for.*

Q3. Report on Market Position of Your Company's Food Products (10 marks)

To: Chief Executive Officer

From: Sales Analyst

Date: July 15, 2025

Subject: Report on Market Position of Food Products

1. Introduction:

This report evaluates the **current market position** of our food items and identifies factors influencing their performance.

2. Market Performance Overview:

- **Popular Products:** Snacks and frozen items continue to perform well.
 - **Declining Sales:** Instant meals and juices show decreased demand.
 - **Brand Recognition:** Brand awareness is moderate but growing due to digital marketing.
 - **Distribution Issues:** Certain rural areas lack proper supply coverage.
 - **Customer Feedback:** Taste and pricing receive mixed reviews.
-

3. Competitor Analysis:

- Competitors offer **better packaging and aggressive promotions**.
 - New entrants are capturing market share through **e-commerce platforms**.
-

4. Recommendations:

1. **Revamp packaging** for better shelf appeal.
 2. Increase **advertising on social media and television**.
 3. Offer **discount bundles and loyalty cards**.
 4. Expand **distribution network** into underserved areas.
 5. Conduct monthly **customer feedback surveys** to monitor preferences.
-

5. Conclusion:

While our food products have a **moderate position**, there is room for improvement. Strategic steps in branding, customer engagement, and distribution will help increase market share.

Submitted by:

Ali Raza

Sales Analyst

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✓ Part-I: Short Answer Questions (4×5 = 20 marks)

1. Briefly explain an intercultural communication model.

An **intercultural communication model** explains how people from different cultures communicate and how misunderstandings can occur due to cultural differences.

✓ Example: Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions Model

Geert Hofstede identified six dimensions that impact communication:

1. **Power Distance** – Hierarchical vs. equal relationships
2. **Individualism vs. Collectivism**
3. **Uncertainty Avoidance** – Comfort with ambiguity
4. **Masculinity vs. Femininity** – Competitive vs. cooperative styles
5. **Long-Term vs. Short-Term Orientation**
6. **Indulgence vs. Restraint**

✦ *This model helps businesses understand cultural values and adapt communication styles in international environments.*

2. Discuss ethics as a communication issue.

Ethics in communication means sharing information **honestly, respectfully, and responsibly**. Ethical communication builds trust and avoids harm.

✓ Ethical Issues in Communication:

- **Lying or misrepresenting facts**
- **Plagiarism or copyright violations**
- **Breach of confidentiality**
- **Offensive language or discrimination**

✚ *Ethical communication in business ensures credibility, compliance, and professionalism.*

3. What challenges do new technologies pose to the organizations? Discuss.

While new technologies offer efficiency, they also bring **challenges**:

1. **Security Risks:** Cyberattacks, data breaches
2. **Employee Training Needs:** Staff must learn new systems
3. **Resistance to Change:** Older employees may resist digital tools
4. **High Cost of Upgradation:** Constant need for hardware/software upgrades
5. **Communication Overload:** Too many emails/messages lead to confusion

✚ *Organizations must adapt and invest wisely in digital transformation.*

4. Define and briefly discuss conference report.

A **conference report** is a document that summarizes the **key points, decisions, and discussions** of a business meeting or formal conference.

✓ Purpose:

- To **inform** those who were absent
- To serve as a **record of proceedings**
- To outline **action items or next steps**

✚ *It typically includes: date, attendees, agenda, discussions, decisions, and conclusions.*

✓ Part-II: Subjective Questions (15×2 = 30 marks)

Q1. Report on Market Position of Your Company's Food Products (15 marks)

To: Chief Executive Officer

From: Marketing Analyst

Date: July 15, 2025

Subject: Market Position Report on Company's Food Products

✓ 1. Introduction:

This report presents an evaluation of our food products' current **market performance**, based on sales data, customer feedback, and competitor comparison.

✓ 2. Current Performance:

- **Best-Selling Items:** Packaged snacks and biscuits remain popular in urban areas.
 - **Declining Products:** Flavored juices and ready meals show reduced sales.
 - **Customer Feedback:** Positive response to product taste and health value, but complaints on packaging.
 - **Distribution:** Strong presence in cities, weak in rural areas.
-

✓ 3. Competitor Analysis:

- **Local brands** offer lower prices and aggressive promotion.
 - **Imported brands** lead in packaging and brand value.
 - Competitors are active on **e-commerce and food apps**.
-

✓ 4. Recommendations:

1. **Improve product packaging** with eco-friendly, attractive designs.
 2. Launch **digital marketing campaigns** targeting youth.
 3. Expand sales through **e-commerce platforms** and local retailers.
 4. Conduct **loyalty programs** and in-store promotions.
 5. Increase rural penetration with **affordable bundles**.
-

✓ 5. Conclusion:

The market position is **stable but competitive**. With branding and distribution improvements, the company can boost its market share.

Submitted by:

Ali Raza

Marketing Analyst

Q2. Define a Proposal and Explain the Parts of the Proposal (15 marks)

✓ Definition of Proposal:

A **proposal** is a formal document that **offers a solution**, plan, or suggestion for consideration by others. It is commonly used in business to request approval, funding, or to initiate a project.

✓ Parts of a Business Proposal:

1. Title Page:

- Includes the proposal title, date, and author's/company's name.
-

2. Executive Summary:

- A brief overview of the proposal's purpose, plan, and expected outcome.
-

3. Introduction / Background:

- Provides context and explains the problem or opportunity.
-

4. Problem Statement:

- Clearly identifies the issue to be solved or the goal to be achieved.

5. Objectives:

- States the specific goals of the proposal.

6. Proposed Plan / Methodology:

- Detailed explanation of how the problem will be addressed.
- Includes strategies, timelines, and required resources.

7. Budget Estimate:

- A breakdown of projected costs.

8. Benefits / Justification:

- Explains how the plan will benefit the company and why it should be accepted.

9. Conclusion:

- Summarizes the proposal and calls for action or approval.

10. Appendices (Optional):

- Supporting documents, charts, or additional data.

✦ *A successful proposal is clear, persuasive, and backed with evidence.*

✓ Part-I: Short Answer Questions (5×4 = 20 marks)

1. Differentiate between culture and ethnocentrism.

Aspect	Culture	Ethnocentrism
Definition	Shared values, beliefs, customs, and behaviors of a group or society.	Belief that one's own culture is superior to others.
Nature	Descriptive and inclusive.	Judgmental and exclusive.
Impact	Encourages understanding and diversity.	Creates misunderstanding and discrimination.
Example	Japanese bowing to greet others.	A person thinking only their language is correct and others are "wrong".

2. Explain the cultural variable of religion with reference to its effect on business communication.

Religion as a cultural variable influences **values, holidays, working hours, dress codes, ethics,** and behavior in business communication.

📌 Examples of Impact:

- **Working Days:** In Muslim countries, Friday is a weekly holiday; in the West, Sunday.
- **Dress Codes:** Islamic culture emphasizes modest dress, which may affect workplace attire.
- **Greetings:** Some religions avoid handshakes with the opposite gender.
- **Decision-Making:** Religious values may guide choices in leadership and ethics.

Understanding religious differences helps avoid offense and build respectful international business relationships.

3. What is a synopsis or executive summary? Briefly explain.

A **synopsis** or **executive summary** is a brief overview of a **long report, proposal, or project**. It gives readers a quick understanding of the key points without reading the full document.

✓ Features:

- Usually 1 page
- Includes purpose, main findings, recommendations
- Written after the full report is completed
- Used by managers for **quick decision-making**

✦ *It saves time and highlights important insights.*

4. What are informal ways of communicating ethics?

Informal ethical communication occurs through unspoken behaviors and cultural practices in the workplace.

✓ Examples:

- **Leading by Example:** Managers acting honestly inspire ethical behavior.
- **Office Gossip Culture:** Promotes or discourages fairness and trust.
- **Daily Interactions:** Treating others with respect and fairness signals ethical norms.
- **Workplace Stories:** Sharing examples of ethical conduct builds values.

✦ *Informal ethics build the invisible culture of trust and integrity in an organization.*

5. Define proposal and briefly explain its types.

✓ Definition:

A **proposal** is a formal document that suggests a **plan, idea, or solution** to a problem and is submitted for approval or action.

✓ Types of Proposals:

1. **Internal Proposal:**
Suggested within the same company.
Example: Proposal to upgrade office computers.
2. **External Proposal:**
Given to an outside organization (often to clients).
Example: Marketing agency proposing a campaign to a client.

3. **Solicited Proposal:**

Submitted in response to a formal request (RFP – Request for Proposal).

Example: Government invites tenders for a construction project.

4. **Unsolicited Proposal:**

Offered voluntarily without request.

Example: A freelancer proposes a new website idea to a business.

 Part-II: Subjective Questions (15×2 = 30 marks)

(Attempt any TWO)

 Q1. Resume + Covering Letter

 RESUME

Ali Raza

House #123, Model Town, Lahore

Phone: 0300-1234567

Email: aliraza@email.com

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/aliraza](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aliraza)

Objective:

To obtain a marketing position in a reputed firm where I can apply my academic knowledge and part-time experience to contribute toward the organization's success.

Education:

BBA (Hons.) in Marketing

Institute of Business Excellence, University of the Punjab

2021–2025 | CGPA: 3.6/4.0

Work Experience:

Marketing Intern (Part-Time)

Creative Marketing Consultants, Lahore

Feb 2023 – Jan 2025

- Assisted in developing and executing digital marketing campaigns

- Conducted market research and analyzed consumer behavior
 - Managed client social media accounts and created content
-

Skills:

- Digital Marketing (SEO, SMM, Google Ads)
 - Communication and Presentation Skills
 - MS Office, Canva, Google Analytics
-

Certifications:

- Google Digital Marketing Certificate
 - Hootsuite Social Media Certification
-

Languages:

- English (Fluent), Urdu (Native)
-

References:

Available upon request.

**COVERING LETTER****Ali Raza**

Model Town, Lahore

Email: aliraza@email.com

Date: July 15, 2025

To,

The HR Manager

ABC Marketing Solutions

Gulberg, Lahore

Subject: Application for the Post of Marketing Executive

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my interest in the position of **Marketing Executive** at your esteemed company. I have recently completed my **BBA in Marketing** from the Institute of Business Excellence, where I consistently ranked among the top students.

During my degree, I also worked part-time with **Creative Marketing Consultants**, where I gained hands-on experience in digital marketing, campaign strategy, and client handling. This combination of education and experience makes me confident in my ability to contribute effectively to your team.

I have attached my resume for your kind consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to further discuss how I can contribute to your company's growth.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Ali Raza

✓ Q2. Define a Business Report and Write the Qualities of a Good Business Report

✓ Definition of Business Report:

A **business report** is a **formal document** that presents **information, findings, analysis, and recommendations** to support decision-making within an organization.

✚ *Example:* Sales report, market research report, financial analysis report, etc.

✓ Qualities of a Good Business Report:

1. **Clear Purpose:**
 - The objective of the report must be defined from the start.
2. **Accuracy:**
 - All facts, figures, and data must be correct and well-researched.
3. **Clarity and Simplicity:**
 - Language should be simple, direct, and free from jargon.
4. **Logical Structure:**
 - The report must follow a sequence: Title → Introduction → Body → Conclusion → Recommendations.
5. **Objectivity:**
 - The report must be unbiased and based on facts, not opinions.

6. **Conciseness:**
 - Should be brief yet complete, avoiding unnecessary details.
7. **Proper Formatting:**
 - Use headings, bullet points, tables, and charts where needed.
8. **Well-documented Sources:**
 - Cite references, data sources, and statistics clearly.
9. **Relevance:**
 - Only include information that is related to the purpose of the report.
10. **Recommendations:**
 - Suggest actionable steps based on analysis.

✓ Conclusion:

A good business report is a **tool for effective communication**, helping management make **informed and strategic decisions**. It reflects professionalism, organization, and clarity in business documentation.

2024

✓ Q.1: Short Answer Questions (6×5 = 30 marks)

a) Write five parts of a business letter.

1. **Heading:** Sender's address and date.
2. **Inside Address:** Receiver's name, title, and company address.
3. **Salutation:** Greeting (e.g., Dear Sir/Madam).
4. **Body:** Main content of the letter — introduction, details, conclusion.
5. **Closing/Signature:** Complimentary close (e.g., Yours sincerely) and sender's name and designation.

b) Examine how to use headings and lists.

- **Headings** help divide content into readable sections, making it easier to scan and understand.
- Use **bold** or **underlined** headings to highlight main topics.
- **Lists** (bullet points or numbered) organize related information clearly.
- Use lists when presenting:
 - Steps in a process
 - Features or benefits

- Action items

✚ *Well-structured headings and lists improve clarity and readability in business communication.*

c) Understand how to respond to requests?

When responding to requests:

1. **Acknowledge the request** politely.
2. **Answer clearly and directly** — provide the needed information.
3. If fulfilling the request, say **“I am pleased to send...”**
4. If declining, express regret **politely and briefly explain why.**
5. **Maintain professionalism and gratitude.**

✚ *Example: “Thank you for your request. I’ve attached the requested report for your review.”*

d) Describe the different parts of a business letter.

1. **Sender’s Address** – Top right or left corner.
 2. **Date** – Below the sender’s address.
 3. **Receiver’s Address** – Below the date, left-aligned.
 4. **Salutation** – “Dear Mr. Khan” or “Dear Sir/Madam”.
 5. **Subject Line** – Optional but helps in clarity.
 6. **Body of Letter** – Divided into Introduction, Main Content, and Closing.
 7. **Complimentary Close** – “Sincerely”, “Best regards”, etc.
 8. **Signature Block** – Name, designation, and contact details.
-

e) Define non-verbal communication.

Non-verbal communication is the transmission of messages without using words. It includes:

- **Body language** (gestures, posture)
- **Facial expressions**
- **Eye contact**
- **Tone of voice**
- **Personal space and touch**

✚ *Example: Nodding your head means agreement; crossing arms may indicate resistance.*

f) Examine how to use visual aids effectively.

To use visual aids effectively in communication:

1. **Keep it simple** – Use clear charts, graphs, images.
2. **Use visuals to explain complex data.**
3. **Label clearly** – titles, legends, and captions.
4. **Limit the amount of text** – visuals should complement your spoken or written content.
5. **Maintain consistency** in design and color.

✦ *Good visual aids enhance understanding and keep the audience engaged.*

✓ Q.2: Long Answer Questions (3×10 = 30 marks)

1. Write the best ways to follow up after a job interview. (10 marks)

Following up after a job interview shows **professionalism and interest**. Here's how to do it effectively:

✓ Best Practices for Interview Follow-Up:

1. **Send a Thank-You Email (Within 24 Hours):**

- Express gratitude for the opportunity.
- Reaffirm your interest in the role.
- Mention one or two specific things discussed in the interview.

✦ *Example: "Thank you for taking the time to meet with me yesterday. I enjoyed learning more about your team and the exciting role at your company."*

2. **Personalize the Message:**

- Address the interviewer by name.
- Include details from the interview to show attentiveness.

3. **Stay Professional and Brief:**

- Keep your tone respectful and concise.
- Avoid casual language or emojis.

4. **Restate Your Value:**

- Remind them of one or two strengths you bring to the role.

5. **Follow Up Again (If No Response After 1–2 Weeks):**

- Send a polite message asking for an update.

- Be patient and avoid sounding desperate.

✦ *Example: “I’m writing to inquire if there’s any update regarding the status of the Marketing Executive position.”*

2. Understand how to write a progress report. (10 marks)

✓ Definition:

A **progress report** is a document that informs about the **status of an ongoing project**, including achievements, issues, and next steps.

✓ Structure of a Progress Report:

1. **Title / Heading:**
 - “Progress Report on XYZ Project – July 2025”
 2. **Introduction:**
 - Brief background and purpose of the project.
 3. **Work Completed:**
 - Tasks or milestones achieved so far.
 4. **Work in Progress:**
 - Ongoing activities and their status.
 5. **Challenges or Issues:**
 - Any problems or delays encountered.
 6. **Next Steps / Work Planned:**
 - Tasks planned for the upcoming period.
 7. **Conclusion / Summary:**
 - Overall project health and estimated completion date.
-

✓ Tips:

- Use **bullet points** for clarity.
- Include **charts or timelines** if needed.
- Be **honest and realistic** in reporting progress.

✦ *Progress reports help management monitor performance and take timely actions.*

3. Identify effective strategies to use in a business proposal. (10 marks)

A **business proposal** persuades a client or management to approve a project, service, or solution.

✓ Effective Strategies in Business Proposals:

1. **Understand the Client's Needs:**
 - Do research and address the specific problem or opportunity.
 2. **Use a Clear and Persuasive Structure:**
 - Title → Executive Summary → Problem → Solution → Budget → Benefits → Conclusion
 3. **Provide Data and Evidence:**
 - Support your proposal with facts, case studies, and statistics.
 4. **Use Professional and Simple Language:**
 - Avoid jargon; be clear, direct, and convincing.
 5. **Emphasize Benefits:**
 - Focus on “**What’s in it for them**” – cost-saving, efficiency, profit.
 6. **Include a Realistic Budget and Timeline:**
 - Show you have thought through implementation.
 7. **Highlight Your Team’s Experience or Credibility:**
 - Show why **you** are the right person/team for the job.
 8. **Design and Layout:**
 - Use headers, bullet points, visuals for clarity and impact.
-

✓ Conclusion:

A successful proposal clearly presents a **solution, value, and confidence** in delivery — it must be **persuasive, professional, and practical**.

Thanks.